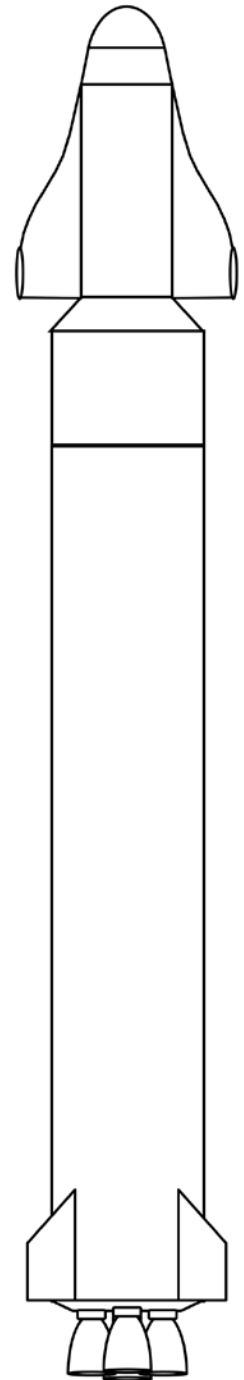


# Fun Facts

Here are some more things about our International Space Station you might not have known... tell your friends! Amaze your family!

## Did you know...

- Space Station's living space is about the size of a 6-bedroom house
- Weightless Station astronauts sleep in any direction with no bed, just a sleeping bag strapped to a wall so they don't float around
- The Station's weightless environment means toilets have to be specially designed to work like vacuum cleaners and suck wastes in, recycle most of the water, and seal the rest in plastic bags
- Weightlessness also makes showering a challenge – water droplets can float anywhere and really damage computers, machines, and so on – so astronauts rub water and soap on and sponge it off again
- There are about 8 miles of wiring in the Station's electrical system
- Over 100,000 people around the world worked together to make the Space Station possible
- Astronauts have to exercise hard for at least 2 hours every day to keep their muscles and bones from getting too soft, which is what they would otherwise do without having gravity to work against
- Over 50 computers keep the Station's systems working
- Astronauts, when they're enjoying what little free time they get, often spend it reading, listening to music, emailing or otherwise keeping in touch with their families and friends on Earth, or taking pictures of Earth and space out the windows
- Research on Station continues to make discoveries important to us here on Earth including, recently, a possible vaccine for salmonella, a food-poisoning illness that is especially dangerous to children



Example  
rocket 1  
(p. 27)